

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1488

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Billie "Bill" Gray Speck of Lafayette.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that the members of this General Assembly learned of the passing of Billie "Bill" Gray Speck, who will be fondly remembered as a devoted public servant, an extraordinary role model, and a beloved family man; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Speck was a humble, generous man who easily connected with people, and his commitment to Macon County and his fellow citizens knew no bounds; and

WHEREAS, a native of Livingston, Mr. Speck moved to Lafayette in 1960 to take charge of WEEN Radio, which he owned and operated for forty-one years; and

WHEREAS, he used the station's prominence in the community to assist people in need, often hosting on-air benefits; and

WHEREAS, in June 2021, he was inducted into the Sports Hall Fame for his work in broadcasting local sports on WEEN for many years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Speck gave back to his beloved Macon County by coaching local sports teams and serving in many other civic and charitable capacities too numerous to enumerate; and

WHEREAS, a building at the local fairgrounds was named in his honor to commemorate his thirty years of dedicated service to the Macon County Fair; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Speck had served as the Grand Marshal of the Lafayette Christmas Parade, an honor that reflects the high regard in which he was held by his friends and neighbors; and

WHEREAS, he was honored as the first recipient of the Will Hall Sullivan Award given by North Central Telephone Company; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Speck was an active member of Lafayette First Baptist Church, where he had been a deacon since 1960; and

WHEREAS, Bill Speck was "the rock of his family," and he loved his children and grandchildren dearly; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Speck is survived by his daughter, Stacye Collins, and her husband, Tim; granddaughter, Brooke Oglesby, and her husband, John; grandson, Trenton Collins, and his companion, Jenna Meador; great-grandson, Tatum Gray Oglesby; brother, Grady Speck, and his wife, Doris; brothers-in-law, Jim Ray and his wife, Jane, and Robert Ray and his wife, Carol; and several nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his wife, Elizabeth "Liz" Ray Speck; son, Steve Speck; parents, Joe May Speck and Janie Ledbetter Speck; sister, Ann Norris; brothers, Othel, Estes, Odis, and Willie Pierce Speck; and sister-in-law, Doris Milligan, and her husband, Richard; and

WHEREAS, through kindness and compassion, Bill Speck earned the admiration of everyone who was fortunate to know him, and we wish to pay our respects to this remarkable gentleman; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Billie "Bill" Gray Speck of Lafayette, fondly remembering his life of purpose and commitment to Macon County.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our condolences to Mr. Speck's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.